How to Create a Consist Operation Instruction

Version 1.0 (2007-11-09)

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1 Placing a Consist Operation Instruction

The most complex instruction type is the Consist Operation instruction and is located on the upper tab.

To add this instruction you press the Consist Operation button so that it is highlighted, then click on the player locomotive.

You can see that the instruction disc sits behind previously placed instructions in a row on top of the locomotive.

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2 Consist Operation Properties Tab

To edit the Consist Operations instruction properties, double left click the disc on the locomotive. This will reveal a properties tab on the right hand side of the screen. You will probably want to pin this tab so that it is permanently visible by clicking the pin icon.

Currently all the fields are empty.

Below is a list of each field and a description of what they mean:

Add to Front: Use this button to create an instruction where the player must add rolling stock to the front of the locomotive. Click this button then click each item of

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rolling stock you want to hook up, then click the siding, platform or destination where this rolling stock currently resides. The instruction is then created with the numbers of the rolling stock listed.

Add to Back: Use this button to create an instruction where the player must add rolling stock to the back of the locomotive. Click this button then click each item of rolling stock you want to hook up, then click the siding, platform or destination where this rolling stock currently resides. The instruction is then created with the numbers of the rolling stock listed.

Drop Off: This button creates an instruction where rolling stock must be dropped off at a certain location. Click this button then click each item of rolling stock that will be dropped off and then click the siding, platform or destination marker where it is to be dropped off at. The instruction is then created with the numbers of the rolling stock listed.

Delete Instruction: To delete an instruction from the list, firstly select the instruction you want to remove and then press the delete icon which looks like a dustbin.

Operation Order: This is a check box that is on by default. With the box checked, the order in which the player completes the consist operation instructions is important. When it is unchecked the instructions can be completed in any order. Errors in the operation order are reported at the end of the scenario.

Display Message: The text entered into this field is displayed as a pop-up message in-game when all instructions in the list above are completed successfully.

Achievement Text Successful: Similar to the above message, except this message is displayed if the whole scenario is completed successfully. This field does not need to be filled in unless it is on the last instruction disc of the scenario.

Achievement Text Unsuccessful: This displays a message if the instruction is not completed successfully. In the case of a Pick Up Passenger instruction, this would be if the player failed to stop at the platform and overshot.

This would not necessarily mean total failure of the entire scenario if later instructions are still completable.

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3 Editing Individual Consist Operation Instructions

The separate consist operation instructions in the list show the location of the consist operation, the allowed duration, the rolling stock involved. If more than one instruction is listed then there is a scroll bar which is used to view additional instructions.

Time Tabled: By default, instructions do not have to adhere to a strict timetable. Unchecking the Time Tabled icon means that the calculated timetable is in force and an operational error is displayed at the end of the scenario if the timetable has been breeched.

Train Order: This is a toggled icon. When it is on the sequence in which the rolling stock is arranged is important. When it is off, the order of the rolling stock of the train is not important and can be in any order. Errors in the train order are reported at the end of the scenario.

Duration: This is the allowed duration of the instruction in minutes. Adjusting the length of time in this field will have a knock on effect for the Arrive and Depart fields.

Handle Off Path: The dispatcher automatically calculates the best path for the train based on all the values contained in the scenario. Deviating from this path results in an error. This could end up failing the scenario.

There will be times, however, when it should be correct for the player to leave this pre-calculated path. An example would be in yard activities, where the player should be free to use any path through the yard as long as the instruction gets completed.

Leaving the box unchecked means the path does not have to be adhered to, and no error will be given for leaving the path until this instruction is completed.

Checking the box means the path in enforced and the player must stick to it for this instruction.

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4 Viewing the Instructions

In Drive mode you can check the Assignment Assistant and see the instructions as the end user would when playing the scenario.

This is how a single Drop Off instruction appears in the Assignment Assistant. The text informs the player whether it is a drop off or a couple to front or back instruction, and the wagon / carriage numbers. For drop off instructions the location were the drop off occurs is also listed. The expected arrival and departure time is displayed and the completion status of the instruction indicated with a red cross or a green check mark.

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